Grant Writing & Fundraising

Finding Money to Support Your Work

What is grant writing and fundraising?

Learning how to **ask for money and support** so your organization can do its work and help more people.

With good fundraising skills, you can find the money needed to run and grow your projects.

Four skills you will learn

1	2	3	4
Writing Proposals	Finding Donors	Building Relationships	Working Together

1. Writing grant proposals

What is a grant proposal?

A written request for money that tells:

- What you want to do
- Why it is important
- How much money you need
- How you will use the money

Why write proposals?

Most donors want to see a written plan before giving money.

Two main parts

Part 1: The narrative (Story)

Explain your project in words

Part 2: The budget (Numbers)

Show how you will spend the money

Both parts work together to make a complete proposal

Writing a strong narrative

What to include in your story

1. The problem What problem are you trying to solve?	*Example: Many girls in our village cannot read or write*
2. Your solution What will you do to fix the problem?	*Example: We will open a free reading center for girls*
3. Who you will help Who will benefit from your project?	*Example: 100 girls ages 8-14 from poor families*
4. Your plan Step by step, what will you do?	*Example: Month 1: Find space, Month 2: Buy books, Month 3: Start classes*
5. Expected results What will change when you succeed?	*Example: 100 girls will learn to read within 1 year*

Creating a simple budget

What is a budget?

A list showing how much each thing will cost

Budget categories:

- Staff salaries
- Materials and supplies
- Transportation
- Rent or space costs
- Training and workshops
- Equipment
- Other costs

Example budget

Girls reading center - 6 Months

Teacher salary (6 months)	$1,200
Books and materials	$400
Room rent (6 months)	$600
Tables and chairs	$300
Transportation	$150
Snacks for students	$250
Other supplies	$100
TOTAL REQUESTED:	**$3,000**

Tips for writing strong proposals

Be clear and simple	Use simple words. Avoid complicated language.
Tell a real story	Use examples of real people your project will help.
Show you can do it	Explain your experience or past successes.
Be honest with numbers	Make sure your budget is realistic and accurate.
Follow the rules	Read the donor's instructions carefully and follow them exactly.

2. Finding donors (Donor mapping)

What is donor mapping?

Finding and making a list of people or organizations that might give you money.

Why map donors?

- Know where to look for money
- Find donors who care about your type of work
- Save time by focusing on the right people
- Build relationships with possible supporters

Types of donors to look for

Foundations Organizations created to give money away

Example: Ford Foundation, Gates Foundation, local family foundations

What they fund: Specific causes like education, health, environment

Government grants Money from local, national, or international governments

Example: Ministry of Education, USAID, European Union

What they fund: Community development, public services

Companies (Corporate) Businesses that support community projects

Example: Local banks, phone companies, supermarkets

What they fund: Projects in their area or related to their business

Individual donors Regular people who care about your cause

Example: Community members, successful businesspeople

What they fund: Usually smaller amounts, causes they connect with personally

How to find donors

1

Research online

Look for foundation websites, donor databases, and grant listings

2

Ask other organizations

Talk to groups doing similar work and ask who funds them

3

Look locally

Visit businesses, churches, and community groups in your area

4

Read reports

Check who funded other projects like yours by reading their reports

5

Attend events

Go to community meetings and networking events to meet donors

6

Make a list

Write down each potential donor with their contact information and interests

3. Building relationships (Stakeholder engagement)

What are stakeholders?

People who care about or are affected by your work

Stakeholders include:

- Community members you serve
- Partners and other organizations
- Donors and funders
- Local government
- Volunteers and staff
- Community leaders

Why build relationships?

Strong relationships help you:

✓ Understand community needs better

✓ Get more support and volunteers

✓ Find donors more easily

✓ Create shared ownership of projects

✓ Make your work more sustainable

How to build good relationships

Listen first	Ask people what they need and want before deciding what to do	*Hold community meetings to hear concerns*
Communicate regularly	Keep stakeholders updated on your work	*Send monthly newsletters or updates*
Include them in decisions	Let stakeholders help plan and make choices	*Form a community advisory board*
Show appreciation	Thank people for their support and involvement	*Recognition events, thank you notes*
Be transparent	Share both successes and challenges honestly	*Annual reports showing results and finances*
Respond to feedback	When people give suggestions, act on them or explain why not	*Create suggestion box and respond monthly*

4. Working together (Coalition building)

What is a coalition?

A group of organizations working together on a shared problem or goal. Stronger together than alone.

Bigger voice

More people speaking together get heard

Share resources

Pool money, skills, and materials

Greater impact

Reach more people and solve bigger problems

Advocacy: Speaking up for change

What is advocacy?

Speaking up to leaders and decision-makers to create positive change for your community.

Simple advocacy strategies:

- **Tell stories:** Share real examples of how problems affect people
- **Meet with leaders:** Request meetings with government officials or decision-makers
- **Collect evidence:** Gather data and facts to support your cause
- **Use media:** Write to newspapers, radio, or social media
- **Petition or campaign:** Collect signatures showing community support
- **Form alliances:** Join with other groups facing the same problem

Real success story

Water project in Ghana

The problem:

A village had no clean water. Children got sick often.

What they did:

1. Wrote a proposal to 3 foundations (used what they learned!)
2. Engaged stakeholders - held village meetings, got community to contribute labor
3. Built coalition - partnered with health center and school
4. Did advocacy - met with district water official

Results:

✓ Got $15,000 grant from a foundation
✓ Government added $5,000 more after seeing community support
✓ Built 2 wells serving 500 families
✓ Child sickness dropped by 60% in one year
✓ Community now maintains wells themselves

Your action plan

What to do this month

- 1. Write a simple 1-page proposal for a small project
- 2. Make a list of 5 potential donors
- 3. Hold one stakeholder meeting
- 4. Connect with one organization for possible partnership
- 5. Practice your project pitch in 3 sentences

Remember these things

- ✓ **Write clear proposals** that tell your story and show your budget.
- ✓ **Find the right donors** who care about your work.
- ✓ **Build strong relationships** with your community and supporters.
- ✓ **Work together with others** to create bigger change.

With these skills, you can find the support your organization needs to thrive